Swanny realises his elbow is preventing him from bowling and also leaves the tour not long after. His career is over and I will miss him, on and off the pitch. Throughout the tour, Steven Finn loses all his rhythm until he's consigned to a solitary net session, not even bowling to a batter, just to remember the feeling of bowling from scratch. All that fun, all that hunger and desire to work, all that collective purpose is, as if overnight, pulled from underneath us. It won't be until we have the benefit of hindsight and recover from the shell shock of it all that maybe we can reflect on the signs being there, that we had started maybe winning for the sake of winning, like it was our divine right, rather than with the hunger and enthusiasm of when we first started.

And in one winter, it's as if a giant machine has ground to a halt. Australia win the series 5-0 and we're back where we started, trying to work out how to win in Australia. The changing of the guard is marked even more clearly when young all-rounder Ben Stokes is brought into the team for the second Test and later in the series, pushing out his chest and fronting up to all the Australian bowlers, scores a muscular, measured and menacing debut century. Johnson's fear factor alone had made incisions into our batters' heads, opened up doubt, and had them playing shots they didn't need to. Stokes had no wounds, no damage – he just came out wanting to be involved, ready to dominate.

We all know that people are going to want blood back home. They're going to say that it's over for this team. There will be lists over the country with our names being checked off and other names pencilled in. I am 31 – not a dissimilar age to Hoggard and Harmison when Broady and I came in for them. I was determined, under any costs necessary, to not be defined by this series and to move beyond what might be my perceived lifespan. I had got here, I had hung on, I had made myself something else, become someone new, and I was not prepared to go down with this ship.